

JKBOSE 2026

CLASS 11TH

THE AILING PLANET: THE GREEN MOVEMENT'S ROLE

LECTURE-1

ENGLISH

HUSSAIN SIR



Topics To Covered

1 ... Lec. 1. (Detailed explanation) The Ailing Planed

2 ...

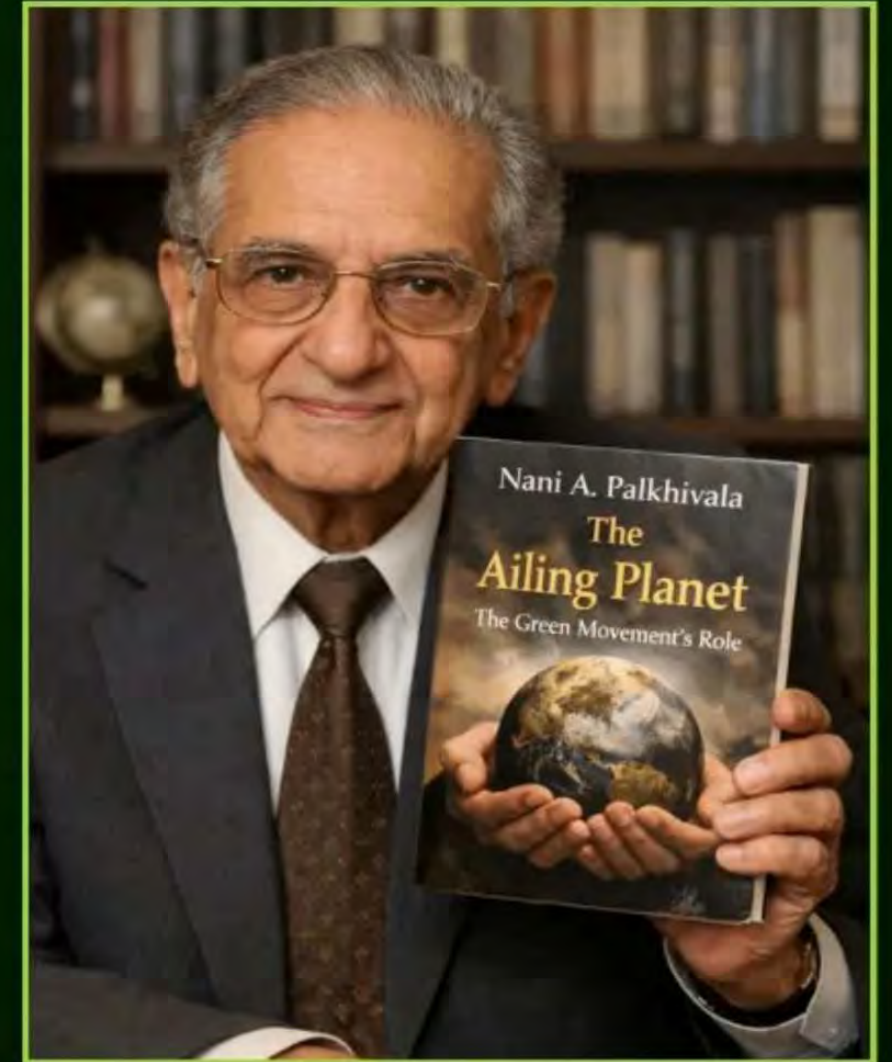
3 ...

4 ...

Sick Earth **The Ailing Planet:**

The Green Movement's Role *Nani Palkhivala*

The following article was written by Nani Palkhivala and published in The Indian Express on 24 November 1994. The issues that he raised regarding the declining health of the earth continue to have relevance.



The Ailing Planet: The Green Movement's Role *Nani Palkhivala*

1994 → 25 years - 7 1972.

One cannot recall any movement in world history which has gripped the imagination of the entire human race so completely and so rapidly as the Green Movement which started nearly twenty-five years ago. In 1972 the world's first nationwide Green party was founded in New Zealand. Since then, the movement has not looked back.

Ailing: Sick; in poor health or condition

Green Movement: A global movement concerned with protecting the environment gripped: hold



The Ailing Planet: The Green Movement's Role *Nani Palkhivala*

We have shifted — one hopes, irrevocably — from the mechanistic view to a holistic and ecological view of the world.

It is a shift in human perceptions as revolutionary as that introduced by Copernicus who taught mankind in the sixteenth century that the earth and the other planets revolved round the sun.

Irrevocably: not reversed

Holistic: Dealing with something as a whole rather than individual parts
ecological view: Relating to the relationship between living organisms (plants, animals, humans) and their environment.



The Ailing Planet: The Green Movement's Role *Nani Palkhivala*

For the first time in human history, there is a growing worldwide consciousness that the earth itself is a living organism — an enormous being of which we are parts. It has its own metabolic needs and vital processes which need to be respected and preserved.

Revolutionary: evolving a complete change

Metabolic needs: are the needs of the body to stay alive and function properly, like the need for food, water, oxygen, etc.



The Ailing Planet: The Green Movement's Role *Nani Palkhivala*

The earth's vital signs reveal a patient in declining health. We have begun to realise our ethical responsibilities to be good stewards of the planet and responsible trustees of the legacy to future generations.

Vital signs: important signs

Stewards: The job of supervising or taking care of something



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The concept of sustainable development was popularised in 1987 by the World Commission on Environment and Development.

Sustainable development: Development that meets the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs.



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In its report it defined the idea as “Development that meets the needs of the present, without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their needs”, i.e., without stripping the natural world of resources future generations would need.

Stripping: clearing



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In the zoo at Lusaka, Zambia, there is a cage where the notice reads, 'The world's most dangerous animal'. Inside the cage there is no animal but a mirror where you see yourself.

Dawned: begun



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Thanks to the efforts of a number of agencies in different countries, a new awareness has now started dawned upon the most dangerous human being animal in the world. He has realised the wisdom of shifting from a system based on domination to one based on partnership.



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Scientists have listed catalogued about 1.4 million living species with which mankind shares the earth. Estimates vary widely as regards the still uncatalogued living species — biologists reckon that about three to a hundred million other living species still languish unnamed in ignominious darkness. Unknown



QUESTION

What does the author refer to as "The Ailing Planet"?

- 1** The Earth ✓
- 2** The Moon
- 3** Mars
- 4** Forests

QUESTION



When did the Green Movement begin?

1 1952

2 1972 ✓

3 1990

4 1987

QUESTION



What is the chief concern of the Green Movement?

- 1 Spreading political awareness
- 2 Saving endangered species only
- 3 Encouraging technology
- 4 Protecting the environment and natural resources

QUESTION

According to the author, what is the 'holistic and ecological view' emerging?

- 1 That Earth is a battlefield
- 2 That Earth belongs to only humans
- 3 That Earth is a living organism
- 4 That Earth must be abandoned

QUESTION

What does the term "sustainable development" mean?

- 1 Developing only cities
- 2 Development without harming the environment
- 3 Development for the present only
- 4 Development with rapid industrialization

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One of the early international commissions which dealt, among other things, inter alia, with the question of ecology and environment was the Brandt Commission which had a distinguished Indian as one of its members — Mr L.K. Jha.

Inter alia: among other things

Scorched: Burned or damaged by extreme heat or fire



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The First Brandt Report raised the question —
“Are we to leave our successors a scorched
planet of advancing deserts, impoverished
landscapes and ailing environment?”

Impoverished: Very poor, or reduced to poverty; can also mean lacking in quality, strength, or resources



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Mr Lester R. Brown in his thoughtful book (The Global Economic Prospect) points out that the earth's principal biological systems are four — fisheries, forests, grasslands, and croplands — and they form the foundation of the global economic system. In addition to supplying our food, these four systems provide virtually all the raw materials for industry except minerals and petroleum-derived synthetics.

Synthetics: artificial substances

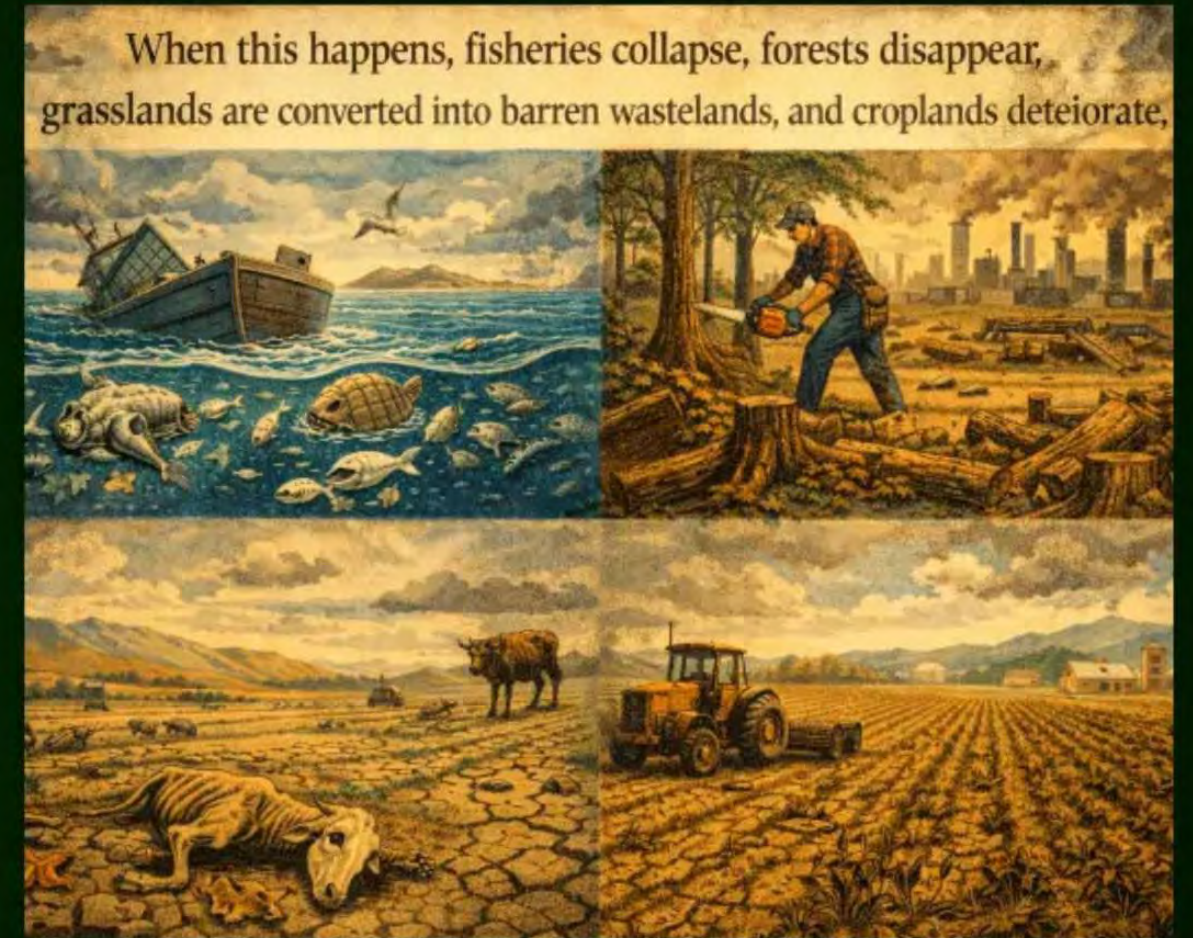


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In large areas of the world, human claims on these systems are reaching an unsustainable level, a point where their productivity is being impaired. When this happens, fisheries collapse, forests disappear, grasslands are converted into barren wastelands, and croplands deteriorate

Impaired: weakened or damaged

Deteriorate: decline



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In a protein-conscious and protein hungry world, overfishing is common every day. In poor countries, local forests are being decimated in order to procure firewood for cooking. In some places, firewood has become so expensive that “what goes under the pot now costs more than what goes inside it”.

Decimated: reduced

Procure: obtain



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Since the tropical forest is, in the words of Dr Myers, “the powerhouse of evolution”, several species of life face extinction as a result of its destruction.

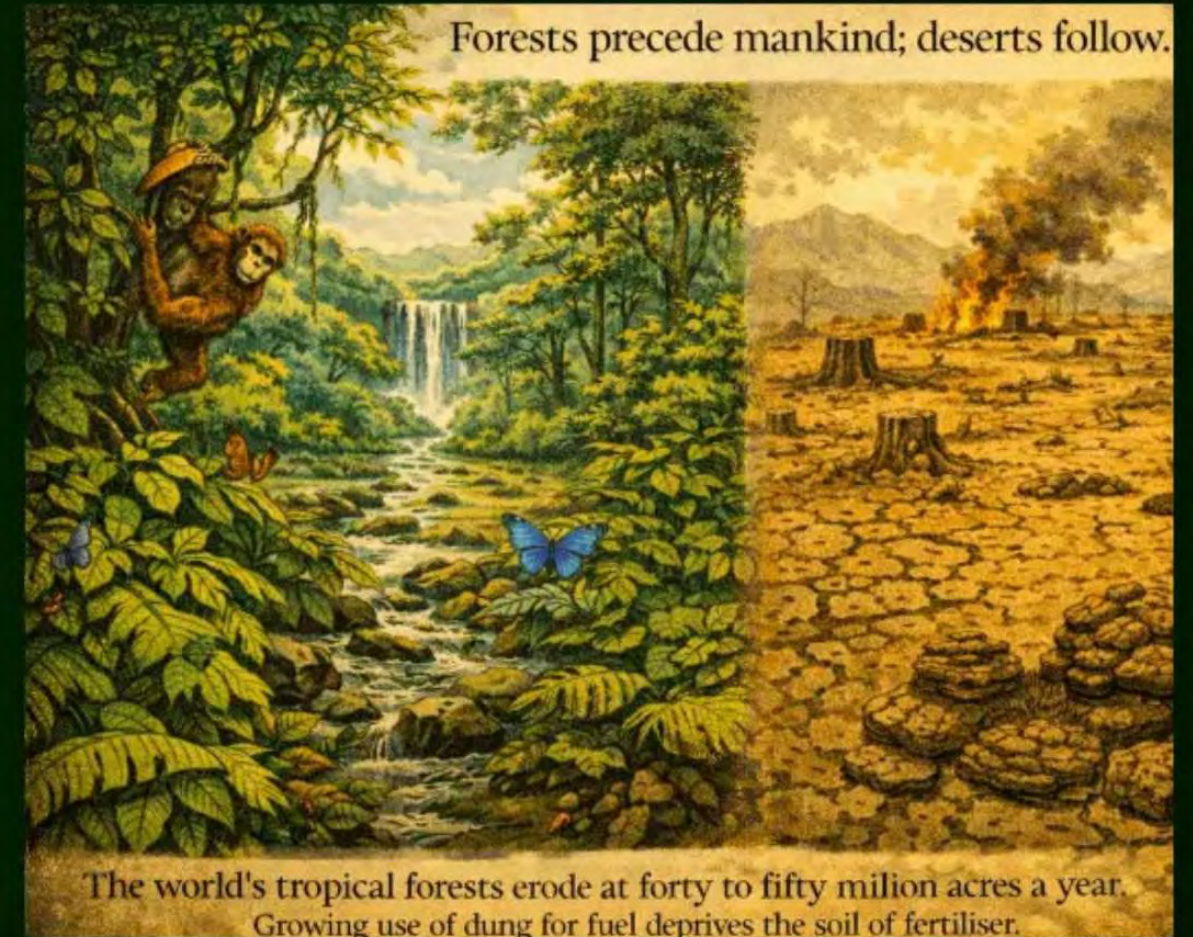


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It has been well said that forests ^{come before} precede mankind; deserts follow. The world's ancient patrimony of tropical forests is now eroding at the rate of forty to fifty million acres a year, and the growing use of dung for burning deprives the soil of an important natural fertiliser.

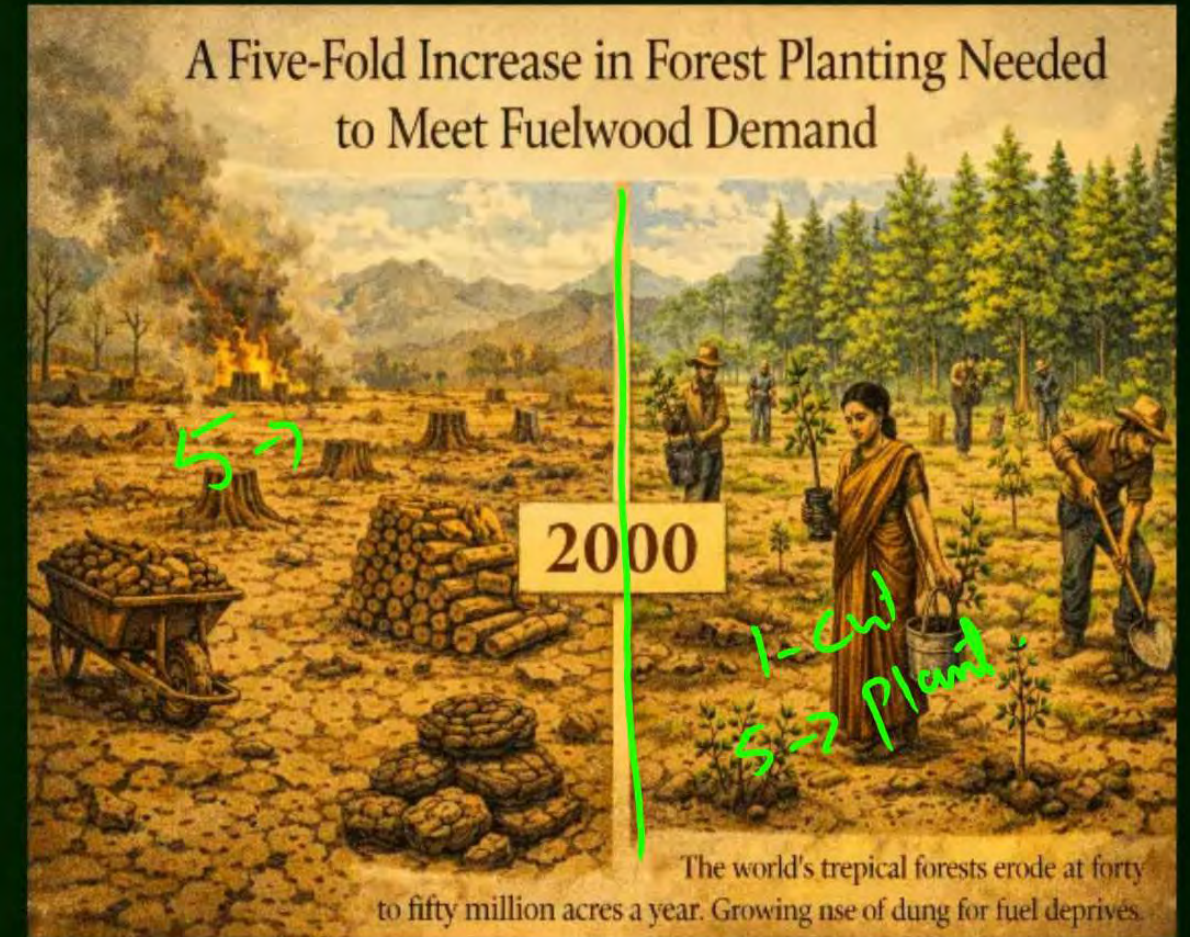
Precede: come before

Patrimony: inheritance from father



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The World Bank estimates that a five-fold increase in the rate of forest planting is needed to cope with the expected fuelwood demand in the year 2000.



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James Speth, the President of the World Resources Institute, said the other day, "We were saying that we are losing the forests at an acre a second, but it is much closer to an acre-and-a-half to a second".

1 Sec. 1

→ 1.5 acre. 1 Sec.



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Article 48A of the Constitution of India provides that “the State shall ^{key} endeavour to protect and improve the environment and to safeguard the forests and wildlife of the country”. But what causes endless anguish is the fact that laws are never respected nor enforced in India.

Anguish: pain, suffering



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(For instance, the Constitution says that casteism, untouchability and bonded labour shall be abolished, but they flourish shamelessly even after forty-four years of the operation of the Constitution.)



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A recent report of our Parliament's Estimates Committee has highlighted the near catastrophic depletion of India's forests over the last four decades. India, according to reliable data, is losing its forests at the rate of 3.7 million acres a year. Large areas, officially designated as forest land, "are already virtually treeless".

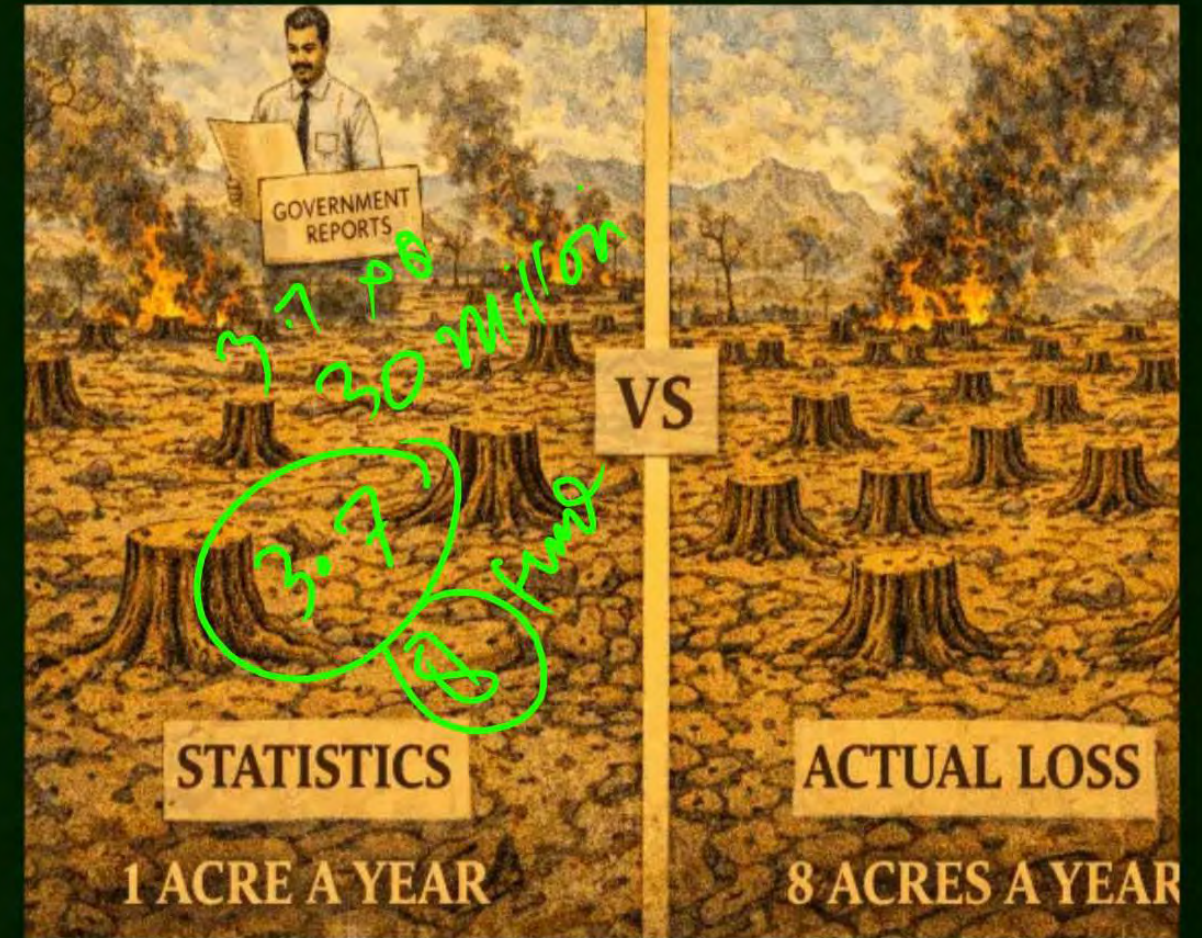
Anguish: pain, suffering

Catastrophic depletion: a harmful reduction



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The actual loss of forests is estimated to be about eight times the rate indicated by government statistics.



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A three-year study using satellites and aerial photography conducted by the United Nations, warns that the environment has deteriorated so badly that it is 'critical' in many of the eighty-eight countries investigated.



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There can be no doubt that the growth of world population is one of the strongest factors distorting the future of human society. It took mankind more than a million years to reach the first billion. That was the world population around the year 1800.

Distorting: feform, disfigure



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By the year 1900, a second billion was added, and the twentieth century has added another 3.7 billion. The present world population is estimated at 5.7 billion. Every four days the world population increases by one million.

1994 →
→ Four days - 1 million



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Fertility falls as incomes rise, education spreads, and health improves. Thus development is the best contraceptive. But development itself may not be possible if the present increase in numbers continues.



Thank
You